

Engines of Growth

Google has created a culture that ensures that its people are engaged in work that is critical, satisfying and creative

By **Krishna Gopalan**

▶ WHAT GOOGLE DOES is not the easiest thing to describe. With a multitude of businesses reaching out to a vast number of people worldwide, it remains one of the most recognisable brands globally. Making all this possible is its large and heterogeneous pool of workers.

Shraddhanjali Rao, Market HR Director at Google India, describes the company as one with a diverse crowd of curious, talented and passionate people. “They build products for everyone, be it down the street or across the globe. We believe that great, creative things are more likely to take place with the right culture,” she says. Her objective, she adds, is to ensure that Google’s employees “find satisfaction in their roles, feel included in their work, and have opportunities to develop and grow”.

Speaking of building a culture, Rao maintains that it should be about fostering continuous learning, agility and innovation. “Our goal is that when a Googler dreams, together we aim to make it happen,” she says. To make sure that an employee gets the best out of the company, internal mobility “is celebrated and encouraged”. Smart talent—that can evolve with the changing

landscape of the organisation—is given priority during hiring drives. “There are people who want to move around the company to grow and stay challenged,” she explains. Among the ways to move inside the company are a number of options available with Googlers. First is a bungee assignment—a short-term development opportunity that also serves the purpose of covering for a Googler on a leave of absence; second is the job shadow option—where a Googler signs up to shadow another Googler’s role; and the third is to work on a project other than their primary one. Learning is another facet that the company encourages, with courses, workshops, seminars and conferences that employees can attend.

At the scale that Google operates, diversity, equality and inclusion are a part of every process in the company. This is where policies focussed towards women are hugely important. “We work hard to create the right environment and programmes to support women in pursuing their dreams and building tools that change the world. It includes the millions of girls and women for whom technology is a powerful key to equity,” points out Rao. The idea, she says, is to support women with flexible policies. An example is ramp-back time that is offered to returning mothers,

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4 GOOGLE INDIA TOP ATTRIBUTES

- CONTINUOUS LEARNING, AGILITY AND INNOVATION
- ENSURING WOMEN ACROSS DIFFERENT LIFE STAGES FEEL SUPPORTED
- FLEXIBLE WORK ARRANGEMENTS

◀ **DRIVING GOOGLERS** Shraddhanjali Rao, Market HR Director, Google India